

SAILWINDOW · GULF COAST EDITION

6-Month Marketing Plan

A working growth plan for sailwindow.com

Gulf Coast sailing decision intelligence — Texas to the Florida Keys

Prepared for: Russ Jamieson · Tucker, GA

Product: SailWindow Pro (V6) · \$5.99/mo or \$49/yr · Live on Stripe

Horizon: 6 months · Budget: ~\$1,500–2,000

01 Executive Summary

SailWindow is a Gulf Coast sailing conditions web app that turns live National Weather Service forecasts and NOAA tide data into a single, plain-English answer to the only question a day sailor really has: “Can I go today?” It scores conditions 0–10, highlights the best departure window, and maps 35 marinas from Texas to the Florida Keys — no login, no download, no chart-reading.

Positioning statement

For Gulf Coast day sailors, SailWindow is the only sailing planner built for your specific waters — giving you a plain-English go/no-go decision in seconds, not hours of chart-reading.

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SAILABILITY / 10

GREAT DAY TO SAIL

Tampa Bay · Best window 10a–2p

Wind 12kt

Gusts 16kt

No rain

SW breeze

Primary goal

Reach 500+ SailWindow Pro subscribers within 6 months, at under 5% monthly churn, establishing a ~\$24,500 ARR run-rate and a defensible foothold as the default sailing decision tool for the Gulf Coast.

Budget philosophy

Spend almost nothing until something proves it works, then double down. This is a solo, developer-run product with a live Stripe funnel — the growth engine is organic reach (SEO, community, marina partnerships) amplified by the product's own visuals. Paid media is a small, disciplined \$200/month test budget, not the core strategy. Total 6-month spend stays in the \$1,500–2,000 range.

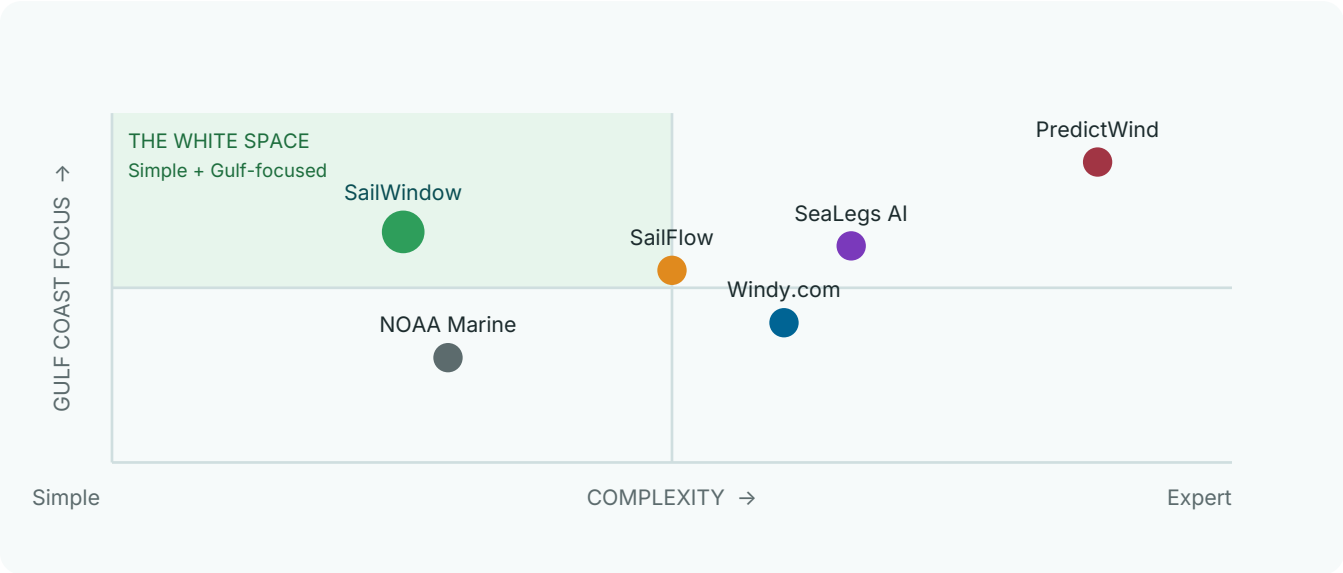
500+	<5%	\$24.5K	~\$1.5K
Pro subscribers by Month 6	Monthly churn target	ARR milestone	6-month spend

02 Competitive Positioning

Every major weather tool serves sailors, but none is built for the Gulf Coast day-sailing decision. That gap is SailWindow's entire market.

The 2×2: Complexity vs. Gulf Coast Focus

Plot competitors on two axes — horizontal is Complexity (simple → expert), vertical is Gulf Coast Focus (generic/global → Gulf-specific). The quadrant that matters — simple + Gulf-focused — is empty except for SailWindow.



Competitor snapshot

Tool	Strength	Price	Why it leaves room for SailWindow
Windy.com	Best-in-class visualization	~\$20/yr	Global & overwhelming; no sailing go/no-go logic
PredictWind	Offshore/racing gold standard	\$29–499/yr	Complex; overkill for Gulf Coast day sailors
SailFlow	Real-time wind data	Freemium	Northeast-focused; thin Gulf presence
SeaLegs AI	AI-powered, newer	Varies	Broad market; not Gulf-specific
NOAA Marine	Free, authoritative source	Free	Raw data, no scoring, no UI

Category strategy — don't compete, define a category

- Own “the Gulf Coast sailing decision tool.” Do not try to out-feature Windy or PredictWind.
- Compete on clarity and locality, not data volume — a score, a window, and a plain sentence.
- Every message reinforces one idea: built for your waters, answers in seconds.

03 Target Audience Profiles

Three personas drive every message and channel decision. The Weekend Warrior is the buyer, the Snowbird is the retention challenge, and the Commodore is the multiplier.

1 The Weekend Warrior

Primary buyer · sails 2–3× / month

Profile	Male, mid-50s, docks a ~34ft monohull at Tampa Bay or Pensacola. Tech-comfortable, not tech-obsessed.
Current tool	Uses Windy but finds the layers and models confusing; often just guesses or texts the marina.
Core need	A fast, trustworthy answer: can I sail this Saturday, and what's the best window?
How we win	Lead with the score card and the best-window band. Show it beats squinting at Windy in 5 seconds.
Best channels	SEO ("Tampa Bay sailing weather"), Google Ads local intent, Instagram/Facebook daily conditions.

"I don't need ten weather models. I need to know if today is a go."

2 The Snowbird Sailor

Tertiary · retention-critical · Jan–April

Profile	Retiree wintering at a Gulf marina January–April. iPhone user. Highly price-sensitive.
Current tool	Free apps and dock chatter; reluctant to pay for anything that isn't clearly reliable.
Core need	Reliability and simplicity — a tool that just works and is worth \$49/yr for the season.
How we win	Emphasize the \$49/yr = \$4.08/mo value, reliability, and the free 7-day trial to build trust.
Best channels	Marina partner widgets, email digests, seasonal referral push, on-dock word of mouth.

"If it's dependable and cheap, I'll happily keep it all season."

3 The Sailing Club Commodore

Secondary · multiplier / referral engine

Profile	Volunteer officer of a 50+ member Gulf sailing club; sets race and cruise days by conditions.
Current tool	Cobbles together NOAA + phone calls; trusted voice members already listen to.
Core need	A shareable, credible conditions reference to plan events and recommend to members.
How we win	Free Pro accounts for club officers + a "Powered by SailWindow" widget for the club site.
Best channels	Direct commodore/webmaster outreach, newsletter mentions, marina partner program.

"If it makes race-day calls easier, I'll tell all 50 members."

04 Channel Strategy

Six channels, sequenced from lowest-cost / highest-durability (SEO, community, partnerships) to small paid tests. Each has a concrete tactic and a first action.

1. SEO & Content

Effort: High · Cost: Free

- Publish one blog post per week on the SailWindow Help/Guide page targeting local intent.
- Target queries: "Gulf Coast sailing conditions", "Tampa Bay sailing weather", "best time to sail Pensacola" and "best time to sail [city]" variants for each marina city.
- Format each post around the product: embed a live score card and answer the query in the first sentence.
- Build a page per marina city (35 marinas = 35 long-tail landing pages) to capture local searches.

2. Reddit & Sailing Forums

Effort: Medium · Cost: Free

- Be genuinely useful in [r/sailing](#), [r/Tampa](#), [r/floridakeys](#), and local city subs.
- Participate on [Cruisers Forum](#) and [The Hull Truth](#) boating boards.
- Answer real questions first; mention SailWindow only where it genuinely helps. Never spam — screenshots of the score card earn more goodwill than links.
- Post an occasional "today's conditions" score card with local context, not a sales pitch.

3. Sailing Club Outreach

Effort: Medium · Cost: Free

- Email commodores and webmasters at clubs tied to the 35 marina partners in the app.
- Offer free Pro accounts for club officers in exchange for a newsletter mention or website link.
- Provide a ready-to-paste blurb and a score-card image so it's effortless for them to share.
- Track which clubs bite; these become case-study references and referral hubs.

4. Instagram & Facebook

Effort: Medium · Cost: Free

- Post one "Today's Conditions" card per day using the app's own score card as the visual, from a popular Gulf marina.
- Rotate marinas (Tampa Bay, Pensacola, Clearwater, Galveston, Key West) to build local followings.
- Hashtags: [#gulfsailing](#) [#tampabay](#) [#saillife](#) [#pensacolasailing](#) [#floridakeys](#) [#sailinglife](#) [#daysailing](#).
- Repost great sailing days; tag marinas and clubs to earn shares and reach.

5. Google Ads (small budget)

Effort: Low · Cost: \$200/mo

- Run a disciplined \$200/month test on branded + local-intent keywords.
- Keywords: "sailing conditions Tampa", "when to sail Gulf of Mexico", "Pensacola sailing weather".
- Point ads to the matching marina landing page, not the homepage; measure trial starts, not clicks.
- Kill any keyword that doesn't drive trials within its first \$50; reallocate to winners.

6. Marina Partner Program

Effort: High · Cost: Free

- Reach out to all 35 marinas in the app offering a free "Powered by SailWindow" widget for their site.
- The widget shows live local conditions — useful for the marina, backlinks + brand exposure for us.
- Start with the 5 nearest / friendliest marinas, refine the pitch, then scale to the full 35.
- Each embed is a durable backlink that also compounds the SEO channel.

05 Content Calendar — Months 1–6

Front-load durable assets (content + partnerships), layer in community and paid tests, then shift to optimization and referral once a trial-to-paid baseline exists.

Month	Theme	Key activities
1	Foundations & launch	Launch Instagram + Facebook; publish 4 SEO blog posts (foundation queries); send marina outreach emails to first 5 marinas; set up Search Console & Google Business Profile.
2	Community & first paid test	Establish Reddit / forum presence; sailing-club email blast to commodores; launch first \$200 Google Ads test on local-intent keywords.
3	Convert & refine	Analyze trial-to-paid conversion; refine onboarding so trials hit a good sailing day; publish first Instagram Reel showing the app UI in action.
4	Regional focus	Florida Keys coverage-expansion pitch campaign; tie content to regional sailing events and regattas; add marina landing pages.
5	Referral & word of mouth	Launch “Share with a sailing buddy — both get 1 month free” referral push; lean on clubs and snowbird season kickoff.
6	Review & Phase 2	Review 6-month results; double down on top channels; scope Phase 2 expansion (Atlantic coast?) and annual-plan campaign.

Cadence baked into every month

- 1 blog post / week on the Help/Guide page (SEO compounding).
- 1 social score-card post / day across Instagram + Facebook.
- Ongoing marina + club outreach — a few genuine touches per week, tracked in a simple sheet.

06 Conversion Funnel & Retention

The 7-day free trial is the entire hook. The job is to make sure every trial user experiences the score card on a genuinely good sailing day, then convert on value — not pressure.

Free-trial optimization

- Ensure new users see a high-scoring day during the trial — surface the best day in their 7-day forecast up front.
- Onboarding should get a user to their marina's score card in under 30 seconds, no login friction.
- Send a gentle nudge when a great sailing day is coming up during their trial.

In-app upgrade triggers

- Day 5 prompt: "Loving the forecasts? Lock in your season — go Pro."
- Day 7 prompt: final reminder before trial ends, leading with the annual value.
- Trigger a contextual upgrade nudge right after a user checks a high-score day (peak intent).

Annual plan push

- Frame the annual plan as the default: \$49/year = \$4.08/month vs. \$5.99 monthly.
- Position annual as "one dock fee" or "less than a round of drinks at the marina bar" for the whole season.
- Highlight annual especially to snowbirds who sail a defined Jan–April window.

Churn prevention

- Send a monthly "Sailing Conditions Digest" email to Pro subscribers with upcoming weekend forecasts.
- Digest keeps SailWindow useful in the off-season and re-activates dormant users before weekends.
- Watch for cancellations clustered after the snowbird season; offer a pause/seasonal option to retain.

Funnel targets

Stage	Definition	Month 6 target
Visitor	Unique site visitor	Growing to thousands/mo
Trial start	Begins 7-day free trial	Steady inbound from all channels
Pro subscriber	Converts to paid Pro	500+
Retained	Active after 30 days	<5% monthly churn

07 KPIs & Success Metrics

Three checkpoints keep the plan honest. Miss a milestone and the next month's work reallocates toward whatever is actually converting.

Milestone	Traffic / Trials	Subscribers	Quality
Month 1	500 unique visitors · 50 trial starts	—	Channels live & instrumented
Month 3	150 active trials	30 Pro subscribers	Trial → paid baseline established
Month 6	Sustained inbound	500+ Pro subscribers	<5% churn · 3.5★+ rating

North-star & economics

- North-star metric: weekly active Pro subscribers who check a score before sailing.
- LTV milestone: \$49 annual × 500 subscribers = \$24,500 ARR.
- Quality bar: 3.5★+ average on Google / Product Hunt and a churn rate under 5% monthly.
- Efficiency: keep blended customer-acquisition cost well under one annual subscription (\$49).

How to measure it (free tools)

- Site & funnel: [Google Analytics](#) and [Google Search Console](#).
- Subscriptions & churn: Stripe dashboard (already live) — track active subs, trial conversion, MRR.
- Reviews & sentiment: monitor Product Hunt and Google Business Profile ratings.

08 Budget Estimate

Lean by design. The only recurring spend is a small ad test; everything else is one-off tooling or free tiers. Reallocate ad budget the moment organic channels prove cheaper per trial.

Line item	Tool / notes	Monthly	6-month
Google Ads test	Local + branded intent keywords	\$200	\$1,200
Social content tools	Canva Pro or similar (one-off)	—	\$150
Email marketing	Mailchimp / Brevo free→low tier	\$0–50	\$0–300
Domain / hosting	Cloudflare Pages (already live)	\$0	\$0
Contingency	Buffer for experiments	—	\$150–350

Total 6-month budget

~\$1,500 – \$2,000

Spending principles

- Prove, then pour. No channel gets more money until it beats the others on cost-per-trial.
- Free first. SEO, community, and marina partnerships carry the plan; ads only amplify winners.
- One dashboard. Track every dollar against trials and subscribers in a single simple sheet.

09 Quick Wins — Do This Week

Six concrete actions to complete in the next seven days. Each is low-effort, high-leverage, and needs no budget.

1. Set up a Google Business Profile for SailWindow — free local presence and a review destination. Start at business.google.com.
2. Submit the sitemap to Google Search Console so pages get indexed fast. search.google.com/search-console.
3. Create Instagram and Facebook pages and post the first "Today's Conditions" score card.
4. Post the current score-card screenshot to [r/sailing](#) and [r/Tampa](#) with genuine local context — value, not a pitch.
5. Email the 5 nearest marinas in the app offering the free "Powered by SailWindow" embeddable widget.
6. Enable the Stripe Customer Portal (noted as pending in the deploy doc) so subscribers can self-manage.

Why these six first

- They make the funnel measurable (Search Console, Business Profile, Stripe portal).
- They light up the two cheapest growth channels (social + community) immediately.
- The marina emails plant the first seeds of the highest-leverage channel — partnerships.

SailWindow · sailwindow.com · Gulf Coast Edition (V6) · Internal 6-month marketing plan prepared for Russ Jamieson.